

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET D — ASSERTION & REASONING SPECIAL****CHAPTER 04: EARLY HUMANS AND BEGINNING OF CIVILISATION**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-D-04

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET D - Assertion & Reasoning Special):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Assertion-Reasoning Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Each question consists of two statements — **Assertion (A)** and **Reason (R)**.
3. Select the correct option from the following 4 standardized choices:
 - **(A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(C)** Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
 - **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.
4. **Section A (Q1 – Q10):** Core Concepts & Theoretical Principles.
5. **Section B (Q11 – Q18):** Evidentiary Proofs, Case Inferences & Historical/Geographical Mechanisms.
6. **Section C (Q19 – Q25):** Advanced Conceptual Nuances & Institutional/Analytical Complexities.
7. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
8. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

STANDARD DIRECTIONS FOR ALL 25 ASSERTION & REASONING QUESTIONS:

- (A)** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
(D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

SECTION A: CORE THEORETICAL PRINCIPLES (Q.1 TO Q.10) [10 MARKS]**Q.1****Assertion (A):** Palaeolithic hunter-gatherers lived a highly mobile nomadic lifestyle rather than settling permanently.**Reason (R):** They depended on naturally available seasonal wild plants and migratory wild game animals that fluctuated across geographic zones.

- (A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.2

Assertion (A): The Mesolithic period is distinguished technologically by the widespread manufacture and use of microliths.

Reason (R): Microliths are minute flint or chert stone tools, often hafted onto bone or wooden handles to construct composite tools like sickles and spears.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.3

Assertion (A): The Neolithic revolution marked a fundamental transition from food gathering to food production.

Reason (R): Humans began domesticating plants (wheat, barley, rice) and animals (sheep, goats, cattle), leading to sedentary village communities.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.4

Assertion (A): Pottery making became essential during the Neolithic period rather than the early Palaeolithic.

Reason (R): The production of agricultural surpluses required durable storage vessels to store grains and liquid dairy products and cook cereal foods.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.5

Assertion (A): Bhimbetka rock shelters in Madhya Pradesh contain prehistoric paintings depicting only modern industrial machines.

Reason (R): Bhimbetka cave art was created by Upper Palaeolithic and Mesolithic hunter-gatherers depicting wild animals, hunting expeditions, and community rituals.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.6

Assertion (A): The Harappan Civilisation is classified as an Iron Age civilization.

Reason (R): Harappan artisans possessed advanced metallurgical knowledge of copper and bronze but did not possess iron technology.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.7

Assertion (A): Mehrgarh in Baluchistan provides one of the earliest archaeological evidences of farming and pastoralism in South Asia.

Reason (R): Excavations at Mehrgarh reveal sequential strata documenting the transition from hunting wild game to cultivating domesticated barley and herding cattle.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.8

Assertion (A): Burnt clay bricks used in Harappan cities had standard uniform dimensional proportions of 1:2:4 (thickness : width : length).

Reason (R): Standardized brick ratios across disparate settlements from Gujarat to Punjab reflect centralized civic planning and technological uniformity.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.9

Assertion (A): Polished stone axes (celts) with ground cutting edges are diagnostic artifacts of the Lower Palaeolithic era.

Reason (R): Neolithic toolmakers ground and polished stone axes on gritty sandstone to produce sharper, more resilient cutting edges for clearing forests.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.10

Assertion (A): Harappan settlements were typically divided into two distinct sectors: a western Citadel and an eastern Lower Town.

Reason (R): The elevated Citadel contained monumental public buildings and elite structures, while the Lower Town was planned for residential housing.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

SECTION B: EVIDENTIARY PROOFS & MECHANISMS (Q.11 TO Q.18) [8 MARKS]**Q.11**

Assertion (A): The Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro was constructed using watertight bitumen mortar.

Reason (R): Builders lined the brickwork with a layer of natural bitumen (tar) and gypsum plaster to prevent subterranean water leakage.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.12

Assertion (A): Harappan cities lacked any organized drainage systems, leaving sewage to overflow openly in the streets.

Reason (R): Harappan street drains were meticulously covered with brick slabs, equipped with inspection sumps, and connected directly to household bathing platforms.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.13

Assertion (A): Lothal in Gujarat served as an important maritime port and trade hub for the Harappan Civilisation.

Reason (R): Archaeologists excavated a massive tidal brick basin at Lothal designed to dock marine ships arriving from the Gulf of Khambhat.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.14

Assertion (A): Harappan craft production was concentrated exclusively within small rural households without any regional specialization.

Reason (R): Specialized craft workshops at Chanhudaro and Lothal produced micro-beads, shell bangles, and etched carnelian beads for long-distance export.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.15

Assertion (A): The famous bronze figurine known as the 'Dancing Girl' from Mohenjo-daro was manufactured using the lost-wax (cire perdue) casting technique.

Reason (R): Lost-wax casting involves creating a beeswax model, coating it with clay, melting out the wax, and pouring molten metal into the hollow cavity.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.16

Assertion (A): Harappan seals made of steatite typically carried intaglio carvings of animals alongside pictographic inscriptions.

Reason (R): Seals were stamped onto wet clay tags affixed to bundles of trade merchandise to verify authenticity and indicate source of origin.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.17

Assertion (A): Dholavira in the Rann of Kutch is renowned for its sophisticated rock-cut water reservoirs and hydraulic management system.

Reason (R): In an arid environment with seasonal streams, Dholavira engineers constructed dams across the Manhar and Mansar channels to divert rainwater into massive reservoirs.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.18

Assertion (A): Harappan trade was strictly confined within the boundaries of the Indus valley without any external foreign trade contacts.

Reason (R): Harappan artifacts, including etched carnelian beads and Indus seals, have been recovered from ancient Mesopotamian sites like Ur and Kish.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

SECTION C: ADVANCED NUANCES & INSTITUTIONAL COMPLEXITIES (Q.19 TO Q.25) [7 MARKS]**Q.19**

Assertion (A): The Harappan script has been successfully deciphered by modern epigraphists using bilingual trilingual inscriptions.

Reason (R): No bilingual inscription like the Rosetta Stone has ever been discovered for the Harappan script, and its inscriptions remain brief and undeciphered.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.20

Assertion (A): Harappan metrology employed a dual binary and decimal weighing system.

Reason (R): Smaller weights for precious stones followed a binary progression (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64), while larger weights followed a decimal system.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.21

Assertion (A): The decline of mature Harappan urbanism around 1900 BCE is attributed to a single cataclysmic foreign military conquest.

Reason (R): Archaeological evidence points to a combination of climatic drying, tectonic shifts altering river courses (such as the Ghaggar-Hakra), and trade breakdown.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.22

Assertion (A): The 'Pashupati' seal from Mohenjo-daro depicts a seated three-faced figure surrounded by an elephant, tiger, rhinoceros, and buffalo.

Reason (R): Sir John Marshall interpreted this figure as an early proto-Shiva representation due to the yogic posture, horned headdress, and association with wild beasts.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.23

Assertion (A): Harappan burial customs demonstrate that they placed copper tools, pottery vessels, and personal ornaments alongside the deceased.

Reason (R): The inclusion of everyday provisions in graves suggests a belief in life after death or an afterlife where the deceased would require material goods.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.24

Assertion (A): Kalibangan in Rajasthan has yielded evidence of furrowed agricultural fields and clay fire altars.

Reason (R): The ploughed field at Kalibangan shows intersecting furrows suggesting two different crops (mustard and gram) were grown simultaneously.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.25

Assertion (A): The transition from Mature Harappan to Late Harappan culture witnessed an expansion of monumental palaces and centralized municipal governance.

Reason (R): The Late Harappan phase was characterized by de-urbanization, abandonment of large cities, loss of the standardized script, and a shift to localized rural settlements.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET D)

01	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & HISTORICAL/GEOGRAPHICAL CAUSAL EXPLANATIONS (SET D)

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.1	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the ecological and subsistence constraints requiring Palaeolithic mobility.
Q.2	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and accurately explains the technological advantage of hafted microlithic composite tools.
Q.3	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains Gordon Childe's concept of the Neolithic agricultural transformation.
Q.4	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the economic correlation between sedentary farming and ceramic craft production.
Q.5	(D)	Assertion is false: Bhimbetka contains prehistoric stone age art, not modern machinery. Reason is true: Rock paintings depict prehistoric fauna and hunting life.
Q.6	(D)	Assertion is false: Harappa was a Bronze Age civilization; iron appeared later in the 1st millennium BCE. Reason is true: Harappans worked bronze and copper, not iron.
Q.7	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides the stratigraphic evidence confirming Mehrgarh's early agricultural significance.
Q.8	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and demonstrates the remarkable metrological standardization of mature Harappan urbanism.
Q.9	(D)	Assertion is false: Polished stone celts belong to the Neolithic, not Lower Palaeolithic. Reason is true: Polishing was a Neolithic technological innovation.
Q.10	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the functional spatial segregation of Harappan urban architecture.
Q.11	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and details the sophisticated waterproofing engineering of the Great Bath.
Q.12	(D)	Assertion is false: Harappan drainage was the most advanced sanitary system of the ancient world. Reason is true: Covered drains with sumps ran along every street.
Q.13	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the archaeological discovery of Lothal's tidal dockyard.
Q.14	(D)	Assertion is false: Craft production was highly specialized in designated manufacturing towns like Chanhudaro. Reason is true: Chanhudaro was a dedicated industrial bead center.
Q.15	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the metallurgical process used by Harappan bronze casters.
Q.16	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the administrative and commercial function of stamped sealings.
Q.17	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the environmental necessity and hydraulic engineering at Dholavira.
Q.18	(D)	Assertion is false: Harappans engaged in extensive long-distance maritime and overland trade with Mesopotamia. Reason is true: Indus goods appear in Mesopotamian royal tombs.
Q.19	(D)	Assertion is false: The Harappan script remains undeciphered. Reason is true: The absence of bilingual texts and short average text length impede decipherment.
Q.20	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and accurately describes Harappan chert cubical weight standards.
Q.21	(D)	Assertion is false: The Aryan invasion theory is rejected; the decline was complex and gradual. Reason is true: Ecological, hydrographic, and economic factors caused de-urbanization.

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.22	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and details Marshall's classic iconographic interpretation.
Q.23	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides the anthropological interpretation of grave goods in Harappan cemetery contexts.
Q.24	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the agricultural practice of mixed cropping revealed at Kalibangan.
Q.25	(D)	Assertion is false: Late Harappan culture saw the collapse of urban institutions, not an expansion. Reason is true: The post-urban phase was decentralized and rural.